

October 3, 2025

Program on Climate Change
University of Washington
Seattle, WA 98195

Re: PCC Graubard Fellowship - Brian McGreal

To Whom It May Concern,

I am writing to strongly recommend **Brian McGreal** for a Graubard Fellowship in the Program on Climate Change. Brian is a PhD candidate in the Quantitative Ecology and Resource Management (QERM) program, and I have served as his advisor since Spring quarter 2023. I have taught, mentored, and worked alongside many graduate students, and in the relatively short time I've known Brian he has made a very positive and lasting impression on me.

The QERM program is highly competitive in that only 3-4 students are admitted each year, most of whom typically have undergraduate or master's degrees in statistics, mathematics, or biology. Brian, on the other hand, received his BS and MS degrees in economics, which distinguished him from others at the outset. This, combined with Brian's various experiences outside of academia, has positioned him well in the program, and in the field of resource management more broadly, because he has a wealth of comparative knowledge upon which to draw and he speaks many figurative languages. For example, Brian's primary research project involves representatives from the National Park Service, the Alaska Department of Fish and Game, the Sitka Tribe of Alaska, the Sitka Science Center, and the Southeast Regional Aquaculture Association. All of these people come from varied backgrounds, use different technical jargon, and represent often conflicting interests, but Brian has taken the time to meet with them individually, listen closely to their concerns, and quickly learn from their experiences. After only a few months on the project, Brian wrote a summary document outlining the different positions, state of the knowledge, and recommended next steps. His report was widely lauded as well written, insightful, and respectful of the different viewpoints.

Brian has clearly demonstrated the ability to distill complex issues down to their more simple components, and convey the importance of each in turn. For example, prior to coming to UW, Brian was the lead author of two *Arroyo* articles published by the Water Resources Research Center at the University of Arizona. The *Arroyo* is an annual publication that highlights a single, timely topic of interest in Arizona and is written for the lay public. It reaches educators, water managers, decision makers, students, and other interested individuals and has been used to inform policy discussions. Brian's contributions focused on groundwater management and Indigenous perspectives on water resiliency in the face of a changing climate, both of which are issues of concern here in Washington as well.

Brian passed his general exam in June 2025 and has one manuscript nearly ready for submission, with a second well on its way. He is on track to defend his dissertation in Fall quarter 2026. Brian's research addresses how climate change, and associated changes in temperature and precipitation affect access to spawning and rearing habitat for Pacific salmon. This research is timely and critical

to understanding the viability of populations who occupy watersheds currently characterized by snowmelt hydrographs, but are beginning the transition to rainwater hydrographs. Although Pacific salmon demonstrate wide phenotypic plasticity, it remains to be seen whether they can adapt to these changing conditions.

I have included a budget narrative and list of my current and pending support on the following page.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read 'Mark Scheuerell', with a stylized, cursive script.

Mark Scheuerell, Ph.D.

H. Mason Keeler Endowed Professor in Sports Fisheries Management

Assistant Unit Leader, Washington Cooperative Fish and Wildlife Research Unit

Associate Professor, School of Aquatic and Fishery Sciences

Budget narrative

We are requesting one quarter of fellowship support for Brian during Summer quarter 2026, totaling \$15,692 (Table 1). This is intended to fill a one-quarter gap in funding between a TA-ship in Spring quarter 2026 and an RA-ship in Fall quarter 2026, during which Brian plans to defend his dissertation.

Table 1: Projected stipend, benefits, and tuition during Summer quarter 2026.

Item	Amount
Stipend	\$10,863
Benefits	\$3,009
Tuition (2 cr)	\$1,820
Total	\$15,692

Current and pending support

My current and pending support for Brian includes over the next year includes two quarters of RA-ship during this Fall quarter 2025 and Fall quarter 2026 (Table 2). Brian has tentative assurances of a TA-ship through the Center for Quantitative Science for Winter and Spring quarters of 2026, as they intentionally provide those opportunities to QERM graduate students like Brian.

Table 2: Current and pending support for Mark Scheuerell.

Award short title	Status	Source	Dates	Amount	Allocated
Indian River Pink Salmon	Current	Natl. Park Service	1/23 - 12/25	\$202,000	Fall 2025
H. Mason Keeler Professorship	Current	SAFS Endowment	7/24 - 6/27	\$150,000	Fall 2026